

Khel Praveen

Physical Education and Well-being

Grade 9



0918

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NCERT

राष्ट्रीय शैक्षिक अनुसंधान और प्रशिक्षण परिषद्
NATIONAL COUNCIL OF EDUCATIONAL RESEARCH AND TRAINING

**0918—KHEL PRAVEEN – PHYSICAL EDUCATION
AND WELL-BEING**
Textbook for Grade 9

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OFFICES OF THE PUBLICATION

DIVISION, NCERT

NCERT Campus
Sri Aurobindo Marg
New Delhi 110 016

Phone : 011-26562708

108, 100 Feet Road
Hosdakere Halli Extension
Banashankari III Stage
Bengaluru 560 085

Phone : 080-26725740

Navjivan Trust Building
P.O. Navjivan
Ahmedabad 380 014

Phone : 079-27541446

CWC Campus
Opp. Dhankal Bus Stop
Panihati
Kolkata 700 114

Phone : 033-25530454

CWC Complex
Maligaon
Guwahati 781 021

Phone : 0361-2674869

Publication Team

Head, Publication Division : *M.V. Srinivasan*

Chief Editor : *Bijnan Sutar*

Chief Business Manager : *Amitabh Kumar*

Chief Production Officer (In charge) : *Deepak Jaiswal*

Assistant Production Officer : *Prakash Veer Singh*

Book Design, Layout and Illustrations

Green Tree Designing Studio Pvt. Ltd.
(Achin Jain)



Foreword

The National Education Policy 2020 envisions an education system that is firmly rooted in India's civilisational wisdom, values, and ethical traditions. The rich intellectual heritage simultaneously enables learners to engage meaningfully with the complexities and possibilities of a rapidly changing world. The National Curriculum Framework for School Education (NCF-SE) 2023 provides concrete expression to this vision by laying out a coherent curricular pathway across stages of schooling that nurtures critical thinking, creativity, and sensitivity, along with the values and dispositions that are needed for responsible citizenship in an interconnected global society.

Learners have progressed through the Foundational, Preparatory, and Middle Stages, where their inherent potential has been nurtured holistically. Now, they enter the Secondary Stage with enhanced capacity for reflection, reasoning, enquiry, and self-expression. Spanning across Grades 9 to 12, also known as the adolescent stage, it marks a crucial period in the intellectual and personal growth of the students. It prepares them to engage with abstract ideas, complex social realities, ethical dilemmas, and the expanding universe of knowledge, while deepening their understanding of the self and the world around them.

The NCF-SE 2023 recommends that the curriculum for Grades 9–10 equips students with the skills that are needed to grow as they advance in their lives. Students can use these skills for reasoning, argumentation, and effective communication. It endeavours to enhance their analytical and descriptive capabilities to prepare them for the challenges and opportunities that await them. A diverse curriculum, covering ten subjects: three languages—including at least two languages native to India—Science, Mathematics, Social Sciences, Art Education, Physical Education and Well-being, Individuals in Society/Environmental Education, and Vocational Education, promotes their holistic development.

The curriculum upholds the principles of equity, inclusion, and accessibility as outlined in NCF-SE 2023. It ensures participation of all learners, irrespective of gender, ability, socio-economic background, or physical limitations. Special emphasis is placed on inclusive practices, disability awareness, gender equity, and culturally rooted

physical activities, enabling students to develop empathy, respect for diversity, and ethical awareness. It is in this spirit that this book, the physical education and well-being textbook for the Secondary Stage has been conceptualised and developed.

The textbook presents a range of themes related to physical education, sports, and well-being, enabling students to connect their learning with real-life experiences and develop a balanced understanding of health and personal growth.

In addition to the theoretical concepts presented in *Khel Praveen*, this textbook focuses on practical engagement with sports and games, including team sports, individual sports, and indigenous games, providing students with opportunities to develop physical skills, teamwork, sportspersonship, and appreciation for India's rich sporting traditions. Overall this book promotes holistic development and inspires students to lead active, balanced, and responsible lives.

While this book serves as a central learning resource, it also encourages students to engage with a wider world of knowledge through books, media, digital platforms, sports communities, and experiential learning. The role of teachers, parents, and schools is therefore vital in fostering a culture of active participation, dialogue, and lifelong learning in the areas of physical education, sports, and well-being. The textbook also integrates technology through the use of QR codes in each unit, providing access to additional reading materials, demonstrations, activities, and digital resources that support both conceptual understanding and practical engagement. Besides QR code also includes content related to sports for the development of basic and advanced skills.

The National Council of Educational Research and Training acknowledges with deep appreciation the contributions of the Textbook Development Team, subject experts, pedagogues, practising teachers, reviewers, and all others who have supported the development of this textbook. We hope that *Khel Praveen* will inspires learners to think deeply, act firmly and confidently, and participate thoughtfully during challenges, both on and off the field. We also warmly welcome suggestions and feedback from all its users for further improvement in the subsequent editions.

DINESH PRASAD SAKLANI

Director

New Delhi
March 2026

National Council of Educational
Research and Training



About the Book

Physical Education and Well-being is a foundational pillar of a child's holistic development. As articulated in the National Curriculum Framework for School Education 2023 (NCF-SE), education must nurture the physical, cognitive, social, and emotional dimensions of every learner. Physical activity, sport, and yoga are central to this vision—building bodily awareness, cultivating discipline, and laying the groundwork for lifelong health. The NCF-SE recognises yoga as an invaluable heritage of India's knowledge tradition, offering students a systematic path toward self-awareness, inner balance, and well-being that complements vigorous physical engagement.

This textbook series, with books titled *Khel Yoga* for the Preparatory Stage and *Khel Yatra* for the Middle Stage, embodies the vision of NCF-SE 2023. It draws on India's rich traditions—including yoga, indigenous games, and classical knowledge systems—while engaging with modern sports science, global sporting culture, and the values of the Olympic movement. It invites students not merely to understand, but to perform: to know why the body responds to exercise the way it does and then channelise the energies towards a better outcome. It also encourages the learner to appreciate the history and ethics behind the games they play, and to develop a personal relationship with well-being that will help them in every sphere of life.

Physical Education at the Secondary Stage is also a space for growing up. Grade 9 students are navigating adolescence—a time of change, curiosity, and self-discovery. This book offers practices that build resilience, self-regulation, mental tenacity and social sensitivity alongside physical competence. This textbook series is built on a carefully designed curricular progression across three stages. At the Preparatory Stage (Grades 3–5), the focus was on fundamental motor movements, basic fitness, physical literacy, indigenous games, and an introduction to yoga. Yoga entered the curriculum here for the first time, gently and playfully, fostering an early awareness of the body, holistic health, personal and social hygiene. Additionally, the learners performed 47 types of warm-up and cool-down exercises.

At the Middle Stage (Grades 6–8), students strengthened their fitness levels while learning the basic skills of two to three sports in each grade, building knowledge of multiple sports and an understanding of gameplay. Yoga progressed systematically—*āsanas*, *prāṇāyāma*, and *dhyāna* were explored in greater depth gradually, and concepts from Indian philosophy began to enrich the practice. By the end of Grade 8, students had developed a solid foundation: physical literacy across multiple activities, an understanding of health and well-being, dietary and nutritional practices, and a deeper appreciation of personality through yoga. In this stage, the students also learnt 48 types of warm-up and cool-down exercises in addition to what they learnt in the Preparatory Stage.

Grade 9 marks a qualitative shift, wherein the scope widens and the lens sharpens. Students now engage with the science behind the body and movement, the history and values of Physical Education as a discipline, higher-order sports skills, and a more personal, reflective engagement with yoga. They are no longer just learning to play—they are learning to think about what it means to be physically educated, and to take increasing ownership of their health, development and duties towards the community and country.

Curricular Goals for the Secondary Stage (Phase 1)

The Physical Education curriculum for Grades 9 and 10 is guided by seven Curricular Goals, each of which reflects a dimension of the holistically educated learner. These goals are not isolated targets—they breathe through every unit, every activity, and every moment of reflection in the textbook.

CG-1	Demonstrates high-level competence in movement concepts, strategies, and principles while engaging in physical activities, including sports and dance.
CG-2	Exhibits sensitivity and learns to navigate personal and social behaviour towards self and others.
CG-3	Demonstrates social sensitivity and mental engagement in physical activity and game situations.
CG-4	Plans and monitors personal physical fitness goals independently.

CG-5	Understands the value of physical activity for health, enjoyment, challenge, expression, and social interaction.
CG-6	Assesses their own growth and development.
CG-7	Learns about tournaments at international, national, state, district, and block levels.

The Grade 9 textbook of Physical Education and Well-being, *Khel Praveen*, addresses its curricular goals through a variety of activity-based experiences designed to engage students both intellectually and physically. It also presents multiple sports disciplines from which students are required to select one, based on the resources and facilities available within their school.

Ideas, values, and skills flow across units as follows:

Unit 1—Evolution of Physical Education and Well-being

This unit establishes the intellectual and scientific foundations of Physical Education as a discipline. The unit situates Physical Education within a broader historical and philosophical context. Students examine how the discipline has evolved over time—both in India and globally. It also opens up the question of career pathways in Physical Education. Students discover that the scope of the field extends well beyond being a player or a coach.

Unit 2—Science and Sports

This unit invites learners to explore anatomy and physiology through the lens of their own movement and bodily involvement at playfields or while engaging in daily routine tasks at school and home. They also learn how regular physical activity, combined with an understanding of the body's key systems—breathing and respiratory, circulatory, and muscular contributes to overall well-being. This includes exploring how the body and brain work together to support a fulfilled and joyful life. Learners develop practical knowledge of warm-up and cool-down routines as essential tools for injury prevention and sustained fitness. The unit also introduces First Aid as a critical life skill, covering key procedures such as CPR and Basic Life Support (BLS), equipping students with the confidence and competence to respond in times of real-world emergencies.

Unit 3—Olympism

Sport does not exist in a vacuum. This unit traces the grand arc of the Olympic movement, from its ancient origins in Greece to its modern incarnation as the world's greatest celebration of human excellence. Learners encounter the evolution of the Olympics—the inclusion of women, the growth of the Paralympics, the Winter Olympics, and the Youth Olympics—as a historical story about human values: equality, dignity, and the relentless expansion of who counts as an athlete.

Unit 4— Sports for All

Students examine the barriers faced by marginalised groups in accessing sport—barriers of gender, disability, class, geography, and identity. They learn about adaptive sports, para-athletics, and inclusive game design. In this unit, learners are urged to step into the shoes of those whose abilities vary from the masses, and they learn to walk along by maintaining the rhythm of steps. This unit develops social sensitivity and connects Physical Education to the wider purpose of building a just and compassionate world.

Unit 5—Sports

Sport is both a personal pursuit and a cultural inheritance. This unit takes students on a journey through the breadth of human physical endeavour—from India's living sport and martial traditions such as, Mallakhamb, Thang-Ta, Gatka, and Kalaripayattu, which weave together physical mastery, discipline, and cultural identity, to the dynamic world of modern and international sport. Students explore combat disciplines, team games, and individual pursuits, developing not only technical awareness but an appreciation for the values—courage, respect, and sportspersonship—that all sport demands. Through this unit, students perceive sport not as a collection of separate activities but as a unified expression of human potential, community, and a lifelong commitment to health.

NCERT has published *Khel Yatra* for Grades 6 to 8 in which eight sports were introduced. If school wants to coach or students want to excel in any of them, they can refer to these books as well.

Introduction to Unit 5 is followed by elaboration of gymnastics and swimming and the remaining three chapters of this unit have separate QR codes in which the required skills and their execution are explained so that the students who want to meticulously learn and explore may have an opportunity to discover more.

Unit 6—Yoga for Holistic Health and Personal Excellence

This unit brings the inner life into focus. Yoga at Grade 9 is not a set of postures to be performed—it is a framework for living well. Students engage with the *Pañchakośha* framework (the five sheaths of human existence), deepening their understanding of health as something multidimensional and interconnected. Practices including *āsanas*, *prāṇāyāma*, and *dhyāna* are explored not only as techniques but as pathways to self-awareness. Through this unit, students build healthy lifestyles by exploring daily practices such as mindful eating (*āhāra*), quality sleep (*nidrā*), and energy management (*brahmacharya*), as well as the importance of good company (*satsaṅga*) and alignment with the body's natural rhythms. Yoga also supports adolescent well-being—equipping students with relaxation, breathing, and meditation practices to manage stress, emotional change, and peer pressure. *Shlokas* drawn from classical Indian philosophy weave through the unit, connecting ancient wisdom to the lived reality of a Grade 9 student.

Structure of Classes, Learning, and Assessment

Grade 9 Physical Education is allocated 90 hours across the academic year (approximately 135 periods of 40 minutes each), in line with the NCF-SE's illustrative suggestions of the NCF-SE. This time is a precious resource, designed to be used sportingly and wisely.

Each chapter in this book contains two interwoven kinds of content. The 'Knowing' sections provide the conceptual, historical, and scientific background that gives physical activity an origin and meaning. They are not lectures to be delivered—they are starting points for inquiry, discovery, discussion, and connecting to students', their peers and wards' own experiences. The 'Doing' sections—activities, games, fitness tasks, observation of physiological processes and movements, yoga practices, and engaging community activities—are the heart and soul of the lessons. They take precedence in time allocation and in energy levels. Physical Education is, above all, a bouquet of flowers—hard work, compassion, joy, and experiential learning coming together to make this village called the world a more beautiful place to live.

The dissemination and adaptation of the content shall be through a playway method, which not only enhances motor skills but also fosters the ability to apply physical and mental skills in real-time challenges

on and off the field. Inculcation of the values and dispositions acquired through the text will partly happen while children are engaged in physical activities or games, and partly by being reinforced during circle time after the game. Sufficient time must be given for circle time during the Physical Education and Well-being periods.

Cross-cutting themes—Indian Knowledge Systems, gender sensitivity, value education, and inclusion—are not separate lessons. They are woven into the fabric of every unit, emerging naturally from the content and the conversation. Teachers are encouraged to notice and draw out these connections wherever they arise.

Assessment

Assessment in Physical Education at Grade 9 is designed to reflect the full breadth of learning—not just what students can do with their bodies, but what they understand, how they reflect, and how they contribute. The total marks allocation of 100 is distributed across the following three domains:

Theory (40 marks)	Sports or Practical (40 marks)	Project (20 marks)
Units 1–6	Fitness, Skills and Performance	Innovation and Community Involvement

Theory assessments draw on the conceptual content of all six units. The sports/yoga/practical component rewards not only performance, but also fitness development, skill progression, and quality of play—recognising that excellence is a journey, not a fixed standard. The project component invites students to innovate and engage with their communities—designing inclusive games, conducting fitness surveys, documenting local sporting traditions, or creating awareness campaigns. Sports activities may extend into pre- or post-school hours when school feasibility allows, enabling students who show particular aptitude or passion to further develop their potential.

At the end of each unit, assessment activities invite students to take stock. These are not merely exercises in recording marks—they are opportunities to develop the habit of knowing oneself as a learner. Reflection tasks, writing prompts, and observation journals build critical thinking and help students articulate what they have

come to understand. When students assess themselves honestly, they take ownership of their learning and that ownership is itself one of the most important outcomes of education.

This book does not ask students to treat its six units as separate subjects to be studied in isolation and then set aside. It asks them to let the learning accumulate, overlap, and speak to each other—the way physical education, in a full and active life, actually does. We hope this book is a companion in that journey—for teachers and students alike. You will surely enjoy this experience!

ATUL DUBEY

Member-Coordinator

Textbook Development Team

THE CONSTITUTION OF INDIA

PREAMBLE

WE, THE PEOPLE OF INDIA, having solemnly resolved to constitute India into a ¹**[SOVEREIGN SOCIALIST SECULAR DEMOCRATIC REPUBLIC]** and to secure to all its citizens :

JUSTICE, social, economic and political;

LIBERTY of thought, expression, belief, faith and worship;

EQUALITY of status and of opportunity; and to promote among them all

FRATERNITY assuring the dignity of the individual and the ²[unity and integrity of the Nation];

IN OUR CONSTITUENT ASSEMBLY this twenty-sixth day of November, 1949 do **HEREBY ADOPT, ENACT AND GIVE TO OURSELVES THIS CONSTITUTION.**

1. Subs. by the Constitution (Forty-second Amendment) Act, 1976, Sec.2, for "Sovereign Democratic Republic" (w.e.f. 3.1.1977)
2. Subs. by the Constitution (Forty-second Amendment) Act, 1976, Sec.2, for "Unity of the Nation" (w.e.f. 3.1.1977)



National Syllabus and Teaching Learning Material Committee (NSTC)

M. C. Pant, *Chancellor*, National Institute of Educational Planning and Administration (NIEPA) (**Chairperson**)

Manjul Bhargava, *Professor*, Princeton University
(**Co-Chairperson**)

Sudha Murty, Acclaimed Writer and Educationist

Shekhar Mande, Former *DG*, CSIR, *Distinguished Professor*,
Savitribai Phule Pune University, Pune

Sujatha Ramdorai, *Professor*, University of British Columbia, Canada

Shankar Mahadevan, Music Maestro, Mumbai

U. Vimal Kumar, *Director*, Prakash Padukone Badminton Academy,
Bengaluru

Surina Rajan, *IAS* (Retd.), Haryana; Former *DG*, HIPA

Chamu Krishna Shastri, *Chairperson*, Bhartiya Bhasha Samiti,
Ministry of Education

Sanjeev Sanyal, *Member*, Economic Advisory Council – Prime
Minister (EAC – PM)

Gajanan Londhe, *Head*, Programme Office, NSTC

Rabin Chhetri, Former *Director*, SCERT, Sikkim

Pratyusa Kumar Mandal, *Professor* in History, and *Dean* (Instruction),
RIE, Mysuru

Dinesh Kumar, *Professor* in Zoology and *Dean* (Research), NCERT,
New Delhi

Kirti Kapur, Former *Professor*, Department of Education in
Languages, NCERT, New Delhi

Ranjana Arora, *Professor* and *Head*, Department of Curriculum
Studies and Development, NCERT, New Delhi (**Member-Secretary**)

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Part III (Articles 12 – 35)

(Subject to certain conditions, some exceptions
and reasonable restrictions)

guarantees these

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- irrespective of religion, race, caste, sex or place of birth;
- of opportunity in public employment;
- by abolition of untouchability and titles.

Right to Freedom

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- of certain protections in respect of conviction for offences;
- of protection of life and personal liberty;
- of free and compulsory education for children between the age of six and fourteen years;
- of protection against arrest and detention in certain cases.

Right against Exploitation

- for prohibition of traffic in human beings and forced labour;
- for prohibition of employment of children in hazardous jobs.

Right to Freedom of Religion

- freedom of conscience and free profession, practice and propagation of religion;
- freedom to manage religious affairs;
- freedom as to payment of taxes for promotion of any particular religion;
- freedom as to attendance at religious instruction or religious worship in certain educational institutions.

Cultural and Educational Rights

- for protection of interests of minorities;
- for minorities to establish and administer educational institutions;
- saving of certain Laws 31A–31D.

Right to Constitutional Remedies

- by issuance of directions or orders or writs by the Supreme Court and High Courts for enforcement of these Fundamental Rights.





Textbook Development Team

Chairperson, Curricular Area Group - Physical Education and Well-being

U. Vimal Kumar, *Director*, Prakash Padukone Badminton Academy, Bengaluru

Team Leader

Pralay Majumdar, *Senior Advisor*, Center of Excellence in Sports Science and Analytics, IIT Chennai

Members

Abhishek Rathore, *State Head*, Azim Premji Foundation, Madhya Pradesh

Anju Gandhi, *Academic Consultant*, Sri Sri Ravi Shankar Vidya Mandir Trust, Bengaluru

Ashish Phulkar, *HoD*, Department of Sports Management and Coaching, LNIPE, Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh

Chirag Patel, *Director*, Physical Education, Hemchandracharya North Gujarat University, Gujarat

Hemantajit Gogoi, *Assistant Professor*, Physical Education, Rajiv Gandhi University, Arunachal Pradesh

Kamlesh Soni, *PGT*, Physical Education, PM Shri DMS, RIE Bhubaneswar

Kavita Arun, *Former National Coordinator*, VYASA, Bangalore

Lalit Sharma, *Professor*, PE, IGIPES, University of Delhi

Lokesh Choudhary, *Assistant Professor* and *HoD*, Department of Yoga, Shri Kallaji Vedic Vishwavidyalaya, Chittorgarh, Rajasthan

Mahendra Barua, *TGT*, Physical Education, PM Shri DMS, RIE Bhopal

Mallika Sharma, *Director*, Physical Education, Institute of Home Economics, University of Delhi

Mayank Sharma, *Lecturer*, PE, Directorate of Education, Delhi

Narendra Singh, *Assistant Professor*, BBAU (A Central University), Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh

Pramod Singh, *Assistant Director*, Physical Education, University of Rajasthan, Jaipur

Prativa Shree, *Associate Professor*, Yoga, Central University of Himachal Pradesh, Himachal Pradesh

Rajender Singh Gandhi, *International Faculty*, Art of Living, Bangalore

Rajesh Kumar, *Senior Teacher*, SBM L-Block, Hari Nagar, New Delhi

Sanjay Saraswat, *Former Deputy Director General*, Sports Authority of India

Shivam Thapa, *Senior Research Fellow*, University of Delhi

Sindu R, *Research Associate*, Samvit Research Foundation

Subir Debnath, *Sports Officer*, MNIT Jaipur

Swathi Murthy, *Yog Instructor*, Prakash Padukone Badminton Academy, Bengaluru

Swetank Pathak, *Senior Consultant*, Programme Office, NSTC

Vineet Kumar Sharma, *TGT*, Physical Education, PM Shri DMS, RIE Ajmer

Vishan Singh Rathore, *Professor* (HAG), Department of Physical Education, Guru Ghasidas Central University, Bilaspur, Chhattisgarh

Vivek Sathe, *Director and Head*, Department of Physical Education, Dr. Harisingh Gour Vishwavidyalaya, (A Central University), Sagar, Madhya Pradesh

Yatendra Kumar Singh, *Associate Professor*, PE, LNIPE, Gwalior

Mukesh Kumar Verma, *Associate Professor*, Physical Education, DESS, NCERT, New Delhi (**Member Co-coordinator**)

Member-Coordinator

Atul Dubey, *Assistant Professor*, Physical Education, DESS, NCERT, New Delhi



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Contents

Foreword

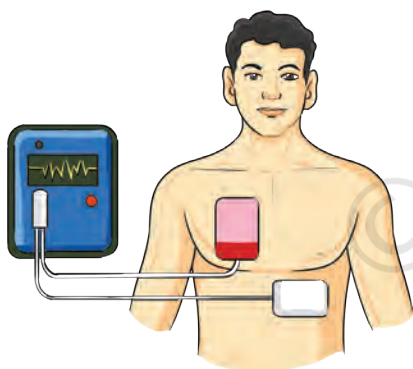
iii

About the Book

v

UNIT 1: Evolution of Physical Education and Well-being

Chapter 1	Physical Education and Well-being	2
Chapter 2	History and Culture of Physical Education in India	10
Chapter 3	Careers in Physical Education	21
Chapter 4	Fitness and its Components	24



UNIT 2: Science and Sports

Chapter 5	Understanding Our Body	30
Chapter 6	Cardiorespiratory System	44
Chapter 7	Growth, Development, and Maturation	54
Chapter 8	First Aid	60

UNIT 3: Olympism

Chapter 9	Olympic Values	76
Chapter 10	The Ancient Olympic Games	82
Chapter 11	The Modern Olympic Games	88



UNIT 4: Sports for All

Chapter 12	Sports and Inclusivity	96
Chapter 13	Sports and Disability	104
Chapter 14	Disability Etiquettes: Respecting Everyone with Dignity	112
Chapter 15	Young Athlete	117
Chapter 16	Women in Sports	122
Chapter 17	Age is Just a Number	130



UNIT 5: Sports

Chapter 18	Indigenous Martial Arts and Sport	139
Chapter 19	Combat Sports	143
Chapter 20	Outdoor Sports	147

UNIT 6: Yoga for Holistic Health and Personal Excellence

Chapter 21	Samagra Svāsthya (Yoga for Holistic Health)	154
Chapter 22	Yogamaya Jivana (Lifestyle for Holistic Health)	163
Chapter 23	Yoga for Personal Excellence	187

